

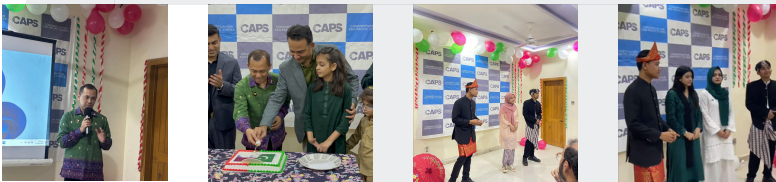
PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

AUGUST 2025

ISSUE #3

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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC



PAKISTAN INDONESIA JOINT INDEPENDENCE DAY CELEBRATIONS

The Consortium for Asia-Pacific Studies hosted the Joint Independence Day celebration of Pakistan and Indonesia. The event brought together representatives from the Indonesian embassy and the CAPS team to foster mutual understanding and explore collaborative opportunities in people-to-people and cultural linkages. Speaking on the occasion, Rahmat Hindiarta Kusuma, Coordinator of Social and Cultural Affairs, emphasised the historical and religious ties between Pakistan and Indonesia.



CAPS delegation visits Indonesian Embassy, reaffirming their commitment to enhancing cultural diplomacy.

A delegation of the Consortium for Asia-Pacific Studies held a meeting with Mr. Rahmat Hindiarta, Minister Counsellor of Information, Social, and Cultural Affairs. Both sides engaged in an in-depth discussion on the role of culture and religion in countering extremism and terrorism. Mr. Rahmat, also thanked President CAPS for providing Indonesian students with the unique internship opportunity.



SVI IN-HOUSE DISCUSSION

Dr. Khuram Iqbal, President CAPS and Dr. Muhammad Shoaib, Senior Vice President, participated in the SVI discussion on "Developments in the Asia-Pacific & Implications for Pakistan". The discussion provided valuable insights into how the region's shifting geopolitical and economic landscape impacts Pakistan.

From reliance to rethinking: US' decades-long bet on India shifts

**CAPS GENERAL SECRETARY
UMAIR PERVEZ KHAN
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH**

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/from-reliance-to-rethinking-us-decades-long-bet-on-india-shifts>

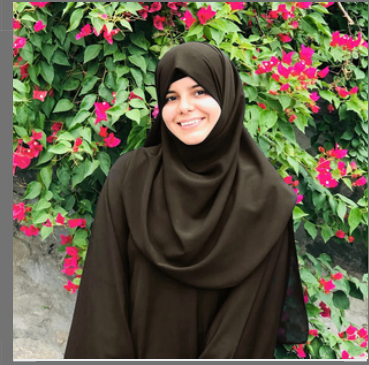


"For years, the US has viewed India as the linchpin of its Indo-Pacific strategy – portraying it as the most populous democracy in the region capable of counterbalancing a rising China. However, the U.S. bet on India is increasingly under question, particularly after recent geopolitical shifts that have undermined earlier assumptions. The U.S. must confront the uncomfortable reality that, despite unprecedented military and diplomatic support from the West, India has failed to assert itself decisively in its own neighbourhood."



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- Tim Kane has been appointed as Australia's next High Commissioner to Islamabad.
- Pakistan and Australia near bilateral investment deal.
- Japan Bank Eyes stake in Pakistan's Rejo Diq Project.
- Pakistan, Vietnam to finalise PTA soon.
- Pakistan gifts Fasting Buddha Statue to Thailand & Vietnam.
- Pakistan to send astronaut to Chinese space station in 2026.
- Pakistan, Japan hold strategic investment talks.
- PM Shehbaz raises Indus Waters Treaty issue at SCO, calls for dialogue on all outstanding disputes.
- Japanese blockchain firm Soramitsu will work with the State Bank of Pakistan on a Central Bank Digital Currency pilot this year.
- Pakistan confirms successful deployment of PRSS-1 satellite with China.
- Pakistani-origin MP Bisma Asif, spoke Urdu in Queensland Parliament and condemned a racist rally.
- Punjab Chief Minister Maryam Nawaz Sharif undertook an official trip to Japan to enhance economic cooperation.
- A delegation from the Islamabad Chamber of Commerce and Industry visited Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.
- Japan has conferred its Foreign Minister's Commendations 2025 upon Ms. Neveen Syed for her contributions to cultural ties between Pakistan and Japan.



Turkey's big energy gamble in post-Assad Syria

**SARDAR BAKHSH & ZAINAB BIBI
WRITE FOR MIDDLE EAST MONITOR**

"Turkey has aspired to become a regional energy hub and corridor for the last two decades. The recent political upheaval that witnessed the toppling of Bashar al-Assad's government from the country has opened the door for Turkey to realise its old ambition with access to regional energy markets. Türkiye's Energy Minister announced the export of Azerbaijani gas to Aleppo via Killis."

<https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20250808-turkeys-big-energy-gamble-in-post-assad-syria/>

Islands on the Edge: The Pacific's Struggle for Climate Justice

**CAPS RESEARCHER
HADIA ALLAUDIN
WRITES FOR AUSTRALIAN INSTITUTE
OF INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS**

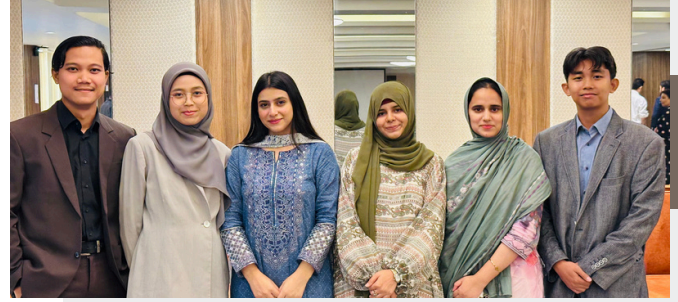
<https://thediplomaticinsight.com/why-pak-must-engage-with-oceania-islands/>



"Pacific Island nations—among the most climate-vulnerable communities on earth—remain sidelined from global climate diplomacy. Despite contributing just 0.03 percent of global emissions, they face existential threats while struggling for equitable access to funding and justice from major emitters. The loss and damage fund also remains inadequate or conditional. The COP 30 and COP 31 provides an opportunity to make amends for the past."

CAPS FIRST INTERN COHORT

SUMMER 2025



Certificate Distribution Ceremony Held for the First Cohort of CAPS Interns

Dr. Khuram Iqbal, President CAPS, and members of the CAPS Convening Committee distributed certificates to students upon the successful completion of their internship. As part of their duties, the interns published Op-Eds in various national and international platforms, helped organise events and aided in the various research projects.